The Sādhana of Two-Armed Hevajra

Hevajradvibhujasādhanopika · Toh 1235 · Derge Tengyur
ཀྱེ་དོར་རྡོ་རྗེ་གཉིས་པའི་སྒྲུབ་ཐབས

The Sādhana of Two-Armed Hevajra, in Sanskrit Hevajradvibhujasādhanopika and in Tibetan Kyé Dorjé Chak Nyipé Druptap, is a short tantric meditation manual. Its colophon names the master Vajrālala as its author. It guides the yogin through the preliminaries of refuge, confession, the generation of the mind set on awakening and the four immeasurables. It then leads him to visualize himself as the one-faced, two-armed Hevajra, also called Heruka, standing on a corpse and surrounded by eight goddesses. The practice goes on to the protection circle, the summoning of the wisdom beings, empowerment by the five buddhas, and the mantras that go with each step. It is Toh 1235 in the Tengyur, in the section of commentaries on the tantras, among the sādhanas of the Hevajra cycle.

In the language of India: he bajra dvi bhu ja sā dha no pi ka. In the language of Tibet: The Sādhana of Two-Armed Hevajra.

Homage to glorious Hevajra.

First, in a place that is secluded and pleasing, the yogin sprinkles every direction with sandalwood and the like, and sits on a comfortable seat. Then he imagines at his own heart an eight-petaled lotus, in its center a sun disk, and in its center a hūṃ. Light radiates from it, and he imagines the gurus, the buddhas, the bodhisattvas and the herukas in the sky before him. Then he should worship them with outer and inner offerings. Then he should confess wrongdoing, go for refuge to the Three Jewels, rejoice in merit, dedicate the roots of virtue, generate the mind set on awakening, offer his body, and rely on the path. Then he should meditate on loving-kindness, compassion, joy and equanimity.

Then the yogin should contemplate all phenomena as empty: oṃ śū nya tā jñā na bajra sva bhā ba ātma ko'haṃ.

Then before him, from raṃ, a sun disk; upon it, from hūṃ, a crossed vajra; on the central sphere of the vajra he imagines a sun disk. Upon it is a hūṃ; from its light Yamāri and the other wrathful ones radiate, and he imagines that they drive away all obstructors. He imagines that they gather back into the hūṃ. From that seed, fully transformed, come the vajra ground, the vajra fence and the vajra tent: oṃ rakṣa rakṣa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Then he imagines the vajra tent.

Likewise, from paṃ he imagines a red eight-petaled lotus, and upon it a corpse. At the corpse's heart he imagines the vowels and consonants transformed into moon and sun disks. In their center is the seed hūṃ; from that hūṃ comes a vajra, and he imagines a hūṃ resting in the center of the vajra's hub. Then light radiates in the form of the eight goddesses, accomplishes the benefit of all sentient beings, and he imagines it gathering back into that very syllable. From the seed and the hand emblem, fully transformed, he should imagine himself as the Blessed One, glorious Heruka.

He has one face and two arms, with the radiance of a black rain cloud, laughing and wrathful, with the look of a sixteen-year-old. In his left hand he holds a khaṭvāṅga marked with a vajra, and a skull cup; with his right, holding a vajra, he threatens. He stands in a dancing posture, endowed with the five mudrās: the crown wheel, earrings, necklace, bracelets and girdle.

The five buddhas are fully pure;
the five are truly the mudrās.
Standing on a corpse, radiant,
his tawny hair curls upward.
Crowned with the protector Akṣobhya,
he wears a garland of human heads.
The protector to be contemplated in the charnel ground,
he is surrounded by eight goddesses.

On the eastern petal is Gaurī,
holding a bowl of a human head in her hand.
In the south is the goddess Caurī,
who stands holding the sun in her hand.
In the west is the goddess Vetālī,
holding a bowl of water in her hand.
In the north, know Ghasmarī,
who holds the nectar of medicine.
In the quarter of Īśāna is Pukkasī,
who stands holding a vajra in her hand.
In the quarter of fire is Śabarī,
holding a bowl of corpse in her hand.
Caṇḍālī stands in the quarter of the rākṣasas;
she purifies with the sound of the hand drum.
In the quarter of the wind dwells Ḍombinī,
utterly joyful in that very embrace.

All of them are black in color,
their hair, tawny as firelight, curling upward,
standing on corpses, three-eyed,
fully endowed with the five mudrās.
They stand in a dancing posture,
holding a khaṭvāṅga in the left hand,
two-armed and with one face,
fully endowed with a garland of light.

Then on a lotus at the heart
one should meditate on the wisdom being.
It is what releases all afflictions.
The protector is the commitment being;
the wisdom being is like him.
What is imagined in his heart
is a lotus and vajra arisen from hūṃ;
in the hub of the vajra imagine a hūṃ.
Light radiates from the hūṃ: the wisdom beings.
Then one should summon them all.
To those whom the mantrin has summoned
one should give a water libation, the arghya.
With joy one should worship the protector.
With the syllable jaḥ one should summon;
with the syllable hūṃ one should make them enter;
with the syllable baṃ one should bind;
with the syllable hoḥ one should delight them.

At the two eyes, Mohavajrī;
at the ears, Dveṣavajrī;
at the nostrils, Mātsaryavajrī;
at the tongue, Rāgavajrī;
at the body, Īrṣyāvajrī;
at the mind, the yoginī Nairātmyā.
All of them are black in color.
The right hand holds a curved knife;
the left holds a khaṭvāṅga and a skull cup.
All of them have three eyes,
their tawny hair curling upward.

Upon a lotus they stand on corpses,
fully adorned with the five mudrās,
their lower bodies wrapped in tiger skin.
So should the yogin imagine them.

Body, speech and mind possess the vajra:
body, speech and likewise mind,
and likewise the mantra oṃ āḥ b hūṃ.
The sky-goers, earth-goers and those beneath the earth,
Mohavajrī and the others:
their hand emblems should be well known.
From the heart of the wisdom being
light rays radiate from the seed,
and one should summon the tathāgatas.
To them one presents offerings.
Then to the protectors
one makes the request to grant empowerment.
One should say: oṃ a bhi ṣañci tu māṃ sarba ta thā ga ta.
By that, imagine oneself empowered.
The five tathāgatas, Akṣobhya and the rest,
the wise one imagines as the ornament of his own head.
The protector Akṣobhya for Gaurī;
for Caurī, likewise, Vairocana;
then Ratnasambhava for Vetālī;
for Ghasmarī, Amitābha;
Akṣobhya for Pukkasī;
likewise Vairocana for Śabarī;
Ratnasambhava for Caṇḍālī;
Amitābha for Ḍombinī.
One should imagine these on their heads.
On the crown ornaments of all of them
one should imagine the principal lords.
One should imagine offering and praise
and the eating of nectar.
oṃ trai lo kyā kṣe pa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svā hā.

The Sādhana of Two-Armed Glorious Heruka, composed by the master Vajrālala, is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The Tibetan "par bu," used for what Gaurī, Vetālī and Śabarī hold, is taken as "bowl" (phor bu); it could also mean an image or effigy. The hand attributes of the eight goddesses differ from those in the Hevajra Tantra and are given as this text states them. The author's name, written as Vajra a la la with the agentive ending, is given as Vajrālala; the Sanskrit form is uncertain.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.